

Connected Africa Summit 2025

The Digital Journey: Vision to Reality

Diamonds Leisure Beach & Golf Resort, Diani | 26 - 29 May 2025

Programme/Agenda

Pre-Summit

Date (2025)	Event Component
9 May	Golf Event
20 - 24 May	Pre - Summit Training
26th May	Arrival & Registrations
26 May (Half-Day) 8:00- 1pm	Lungalunga - Horohoro Cross-Border Launch (MICDE/TTCL)

Day 1: Monday, 26 May 2025

Theme: Workshops, Special Interest Groups & Strategy Sessions

Time (EAT)	Event Component
08:00 - 10:30	Registration & Networking
10:30 - 11:00	Coffee Break
11:00 - 11:30	Summit Overview & Briefing (Dr Meister Hall) Welcome Remarks - MC Welcome Video - The Journey of Connected Africa Summit Summit Overview - Ms. Pauline Wamuyu Kimotho, Director, Legal Services & Corporations Secretary, The ICT Authority - Mr. Kevin Atibu, Deputy Director, Innovation & Incubation, The ICT Authority
11:30 - 12:30	Youth and The Future of Work (Dr Meister Hall) Keynote Remarks Smart Teams - Building The Augmented Workforce - Mr. David Mugonyi, Director General, Communications Authority of Kenya - Shehzaad Noormahomed, Regional Sales Director, Citrix Panel Discussion From Side Hustle to Scale-Up - Youth Entrepreneurship in the Age of AI & Gig Economy The World Bank estimates that by 2025, 100 million Africans are expected to be part of the gig economy, tapping into entrepreneurship as a viable career path, especially for the youth. How can the youth monetise their skills and passion? What are the distinct challenges for young entrepreneurs in emerging markets? How can AI help? What digital tools and platforms are needed to scale and build these businesses? Moderator - Ms. Pauline Wamuyu Kimotho, Director, Legal Services & Corporations Secretary, The ICT Authority Panelists - Ms. Mumbi Ndung'u, Chief Executive Officer and Founder, Power Learn Project - Mr. Timothy Odhiambo Owase, CEO, Kenya Film Commission - Dr. Dr. Ehud Gachugu- Ag Deputy CEO and Global Director Youth & Jobs at KEPSA

	- Ken Mwenda Gikunda, Cofounder and Managing Director at eMobilis Technology Training Institute - Mr. Franklin Mogoi, Head of Qhala Lab, Qhala - Mr. Eric McGee, Technical Sales Engineer, Ivanti		
12:30 - 14:00	Lunch, Networking, Exhibition Walk & Press-Briefing		
14:00 - 15:30	Climate & Technology Solutions (Dr Meister Hall) Remarks Policy as a Climate Tech Catalyst for Innovation & Green Energy - Alex Wachira, Permanent Secretary, State Department for Energy Panel Discussion Beyond Buzzwords: Amplifying Disruptive Sustainability Tech Climate tech attracts often superficial discussions that demand concrete solutions and accountability. This discussion focuses on the need to rapid, transformative change while underscoring technologies that can fundamentally drive the conversation and alter existing systems. Moderator - Ms. Deborah Ngina Mutungi, Group Head of ICT, Sarova Hotels Panelists - Ms. Viola Kirui, Co-Founder and Director, Geospatial Research International - Josephine Ndambuki, Konza - Prof. Kibet Langat, Director, Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture & Technology (JKUAT) Industrial Park	5G Technology & Connectivity (Jumuika) Remarks 5G and Beyond: Building Africa's Future Tech Ecosystem - Cynthia Kropac, Chief Enterprise Business Officer Safaricom PLC - Eng Daniel Obam, Independent Telecommunications Consultant Panel Discussion From 4G To 5G: The Challenges & Opportunities of Transitioning Africa's Telecom Industry The shift from 4G to 5G presents both massive opportunities and significant challenges for Africa's telecom industry. Hurdles, such as spectrum allocation, financing 5G infrastructure, and navigating regulatory frameworks, as well as the steps needed to drive sustainable, inclusive Moderator - Kevin Namunwa, Tech Writer, CIO Africa by dx5 Panelists - Detecon - Cynthia Kropac, Chief Enterprise Business Officer Safaricom PLC	BPO Track (Powered by GIZ) (Kongomano) Remarks - Milou Vanmulken, Programme Manager, EU Delegation to Kenya Positioning Kenya as Africa's Next Hub for Outsourcing IT-Enabled Services (ITES) Keynote - Eng. John Tanui, Principal Secretary, Ministry of Information, Communications and The Digital Economy Kenya, renowned as a regional economic and technological leader is strategically positioned to emerge as Africa's premier hub for outsourcing IT-enabled services (ITES). With a vibrant digital economy, growing talent pool, improving infrastructure, and favorable regulatory frameworks, Kenya presents substantial opportunities to attract global investments and partnerships in the ITES sector. Moderator - Joerg Uehlin, Project Manager, Digital Transformation Centre/Digital Dialogues, GIZ Kenya Panelists - John Kiria, Director E-Commerce & Entrepreneurship, Ministry of Information, Communications and The Digital Economy - John Mwendwa, Chief Executive Officer, Kenya Investment Authority (KenInvest) - Dr. Ehud Gachugu, Ag Deputy CEO and Global Director Youth & Jobs at KEPISA Q&A Session (15 minutes)
15:30 - 16:00	Coffee Break		
16:00 - 18:00	B2B Networking, Exhibition Walk, Beach Games		
18:00 - 18:30	Welcome Cocktail		

18:30 - 20:00	Kenyan-Themed Welcome Dinner (Bustani) Speakers - Mr. Stanley Kamanguya, OGW, Chief Executive Officer, The ICT Authority - Lily Ng'ok, Board Chair, The ICT Authority - Eng. John Tanui, CBS, Principal Secretary, SD for ICT & Digital Economy, MICDE - Mr. Stephen Isaboke, MBS, Principal Secretary, SD for Broadcasting & Telecommunication, MICDE - HE. Hon. William Kabogo Gitau, Cabinet Secretary, Ministry of Information Communication and the Digital Economy	
20:30 - 21:30	Fireside Chat	Fireside Chat

Day 2: Tuesday, 27 May 2025

Theme: AI, Digital Transformation & Smart Regulation

Time (EAT)	Event Component
08:00 - 08:30	Morning Networking
08:30 - 09:30	Opening Ceremony (Dr Meister) Welcome Remarks - Mr. Stanley Kamanguya, OGW, Chief Executive Officer, The ICT Authority Special Remarks - H.E. Fatuma Achani, Governor, County Government of Kwale - Lily Ng'ok, Board Chair, The ICT Authority - Eng. John Tanui, CBS, Principal Secretary, State Department for ICT and the Digital Economy, Government of Kenya - H.E. Hon. William Kabogo Gitau, Cabinet Secretary, Ministry of Information, Communications and The Digital Economy, Government of Kenya
09:30 - 10:00	Exhibition Walk & Show Case
10:00 - 10:30	Coffee Break
10:30 - 11:30	Ministerial Panel (Dr Meister) Keynote Address Building The Rails For AI: Laying the Foundations for Africa's Intelligent Economy - Jyoti Ball, General Manager, Sub-Saharan Africa, Amazon Web Services - Cynthia Kropac, Chief Enterprise Business Officer Safaricom PLC Panel Discussion The Missing Link: Why Digital Infrastructure Must Come Before AI Africa is experiencing a surge in interest around Artificial Intelligence (AI), but the continent risks building castles in the sky if it skips the groundwork: robust, inclusive, and accessible digital infrastructure. Without reliable connectivity, compute power, clean data pipelines, and energy resilience, AI can't move from pilot to scale. This session makes a

	case for infrastructure-first thinking — exploring how fibre, data centres, cloud ecosystems, and energy access are non-negotiables if Africa is to have a meaningful seat at the AI table. Moderator - H.E. Philip Thigo, MBS, Special Envoy on Technology, The Republic of Kenya Panelists - Hon. Mariam Hamadou Ali, Digital Economy and Innovation Minister, Djibouti - Hon. Michael Makuei Lueth, Information, Communication and Technology Minister, South Sudan - Hon. Emma Inamutilla Theofelus, Information and Communication Technology Minister, Namibia - Jama Hassan Khalif, Telecommunications Minister, Somalia		
11:30 - 12:30	Digital Inclusion, Equity and Constitutional Rights (Dr Meister) Keynote Address Bridging The Digital Divide: Ensuring Equitable Access as a Constitutional Right - Hon. Dorcas A. Oduor, OGW, EBS, Attorney General, Republic of Kenya Panel Discussion Infrastructure, Investment, And the Politics of Access: Who Pays for Africa's Digital Revolution? It's one thing to agree that digital access is a rights issue. It's another to figure out who will finance and build the networks to make this a reality. Igniting the debate around the economics and politics of digital infrastructure, this discussion asks; should governments subsidise rural connectivity? Are telcos doing enough, or are they prioritising profits over people? What's the role of Big Tech, public-private partnerships, and foreign investors? Unpack the complex tug-of-war between public good and commercial interests, and what will it take to finally close the digital divide in Africa? Moderator - Ms. Rahma Jillo, Director, The ICT Authority Panelists - Eng. Napoleon Adok, Director General, National Communication Authority, South Sudan - Ms. Evelyn Cheluget, OGW, Director General, Immigration Services - Lilian Njoroge, Innovation Specialist, UNICEF - Eliud Chemweno, Head, EdTech Ecosystems, Centre for Innovative Teaching and Learning, Mastercard Foundation		
12:30 - 14:00	Lunch, Networking, Exhibition Walk & Press-Briefing		
1400 - 15:30	AI & Digital Transformation (Dr Meister) Remarks Reimagining Public Sector Through AI & Digital Infrastructure - Jorge Colotto, CEO, Ideology - Abdelaziz Saidu, Leader, Solutions Engineering, Cisco - Google Panel Discussion What Does It Take to Build An AI-Ready Public Sector? AI holds transformative potential for government from predictive	Data & Governance (Kongamano) Remarks The Infrastructure of Trust: AI, Data & Digital Governance - Ravi Baldev Singh, Senior Director, Sales Engineering - Emerging Markets CEE, CIS & META, Commvault - Immaculate Kassait, Data Commissioner, Office of the Data Protection Commissioner (ODPC) Panel Discussion Controlling Data: Africa's Path to Digital Independence	Health Track (Jumuika) Remarks Digital Care: How Technology Is Shaping Access, Care & Delivery Dr Fredrick Ouma Oluga, PS, Medical Services, Ministry of Health Panel Discussion AI In Healthcare: From Diagnosis To Delivery From interpreting scans in seconds to optimising medication supply chains, AI is becoming a silent partner in Africa's healthcare transformation. AI-powered tools are being used across the entire care continuum—from early diagnostics to clinical decision support, drug discovery,

	policy-making to automating service delivery. But becoming “AI-ready” is not just about tools or buzzwords. It requires deep cultural, structural, and infrastructural shifts within the public sector. This panel brings together minds that will unpack what AI readiness really looks like – and what it takes to get there. Moderator - Mr. Michael Otieno Odhiambo, Director, Shared Services, ICT Authority of Kenya Panelists - Eng. Dr. Dennis N. Mwigusa, Executive Director, Africa Research Institute For AI - ARIFA - Mr. Jesse Samasuwo, Senior Manager, Policy and Insights, Apolitical - Robin Njiru, Regional Lead Public Sector, West, East & Central Africa, AWS - Alfred Ongere, Founder & CEO, Ai Kenya	As we become increasingly aware of the value of our data and the need to protect it, so is the rise of data sovereignty. It gives African states control over collection, storage and use within borders even as laws and regulations emerge. Data sovereignty is vital for national security, economic development and the protection of citizen’s privacy. Moderator - Mary Kerema, OGW, Secretary ICT, E-Government and Digital Economy, Ministry of IC&DE Panelists - George Njau, Director General, NTSA - Mohammed Arafa, System Engineer, ME & Africa, BlackBerry - Nitish Rucktooa, Cohesity, Regional Sales Director - Shadrack Anyuo, Senior Solution Architect, Amazon - Milou Vanmulken, Programme Manager Digitalisation, Delegation of the European Union to Kenya, Web Services - Victor Odada, Head of M-Pesa Payments	and personalised care—all while tackling real African challenges like workforce shortages and rural access. But while technology is promising, implementation is everything. How do we ensure these innovations are accurate, equitable, and explainable? And how can African innovators build AI solutions that reflect local health realities, languages, and data contexts? Moderator - Moses Kemibaro, CEO, Dotsavvy Panelists - Mr. Geoffrey Gitagia, Group Information Technology Manager, Avenue Healthcare, Kenya - Mr. Anthony Lenaiyara, Chief Executive Officer, Digital Health Agency, Kenya - Boniface Mungania, Director of Public Sector Digital Transformation, Safaricom - Kellington Kituku, Public Sector Lead for East Africa, AWS
15:30 - 15:45	Transition Health Break		
15:45 - 17:15	Cybersecurity (Dr Meister) Remarks Cybersecurity By Design: Embedding Trust into Digital Infrastructure - Andries Lategan, Regional Technical Sales Director, Broadcom - Kelvin Mugambi, Security Architect - Sub Saharan Africa, Cisco Panel Discussion AI On Both Sides: Fighting Cybercrime With AI Agents Cybercriminals are no longer lone actors with malware kits — they’re now deploying sophisticated AI-driven attacks that adapt, learn, and evolve. But the defenders are also armed: AI agents, trained on	IoT & Smart Infrastructure (Kongamano) Remarks Africa’s Leap: IoT Driven Infrastructure for A Connected Continent Keynote: Saleh Al-Nemer, CT & Distinguished Technologist, UKIMEA O-CTO & Vertical Solutions Panel Discussion Smarter Systems, Better Cities: Unleashing IoT for Infrastructure That Works Africa’s urban centers are growing fast — but infrastructure often struggles to keep up. Enter IoT. From traffic flow optimisation to smart waste collection, connected sensors and intelligent systems can radically improve how cities function. IoT can be used to build cities that are not	Last Mile Infrastructure Financing (Powered by XXX) (Jumuika) Session Overview The Government of Kenya is driving an ambitious expansion of digital infrastructure to bring connectivity closer to its citizens, as outlined in the National Digital Masterplan. This plan targets the deployment of 100,000 km of terrestrial fiber, 25,000 public Wi-Fi hotspots, and 1,400 digital hubs. Key initiatives, including the Digital Superhighway and the Kenya Digital Economy Acceleration Project (KDEAP), prioritise last-mile connectivity to achieve a digitally empowered Kenya within five years. Moderator - Harry Hare, Co-Founder, CIO Africa Panelists - Thomas Bwaley, Director, Standards and Programmes, The ICT Authority

	massive datasets, are becoming frontline protectors in digital infrastructure. There is an escalating arms race where AI is both the sword and the shield – and Africa is fast becoming a critical front. Moderator - Mr. Philip Irode, Deputy Director Information Security, ICT Authority Panelists - Mr. Emmanuel Kata Kimeu, Secretary, ICT - Security and Audit Control, MICDE - Imran Chaudhrey, Country Manager East Africa, Fortinet - Grant van Eck, Regional Director Sub-Sahara Africa, Ivanti - Samer Hani, Managing Director, META, EE, GR, Matrix42 - Dr. Vincent Ngundi, Ag. Director Cybersecurity, Communications Authority of Kenya - Lorna Hardie, Regional Director Africa - Check Point Software Technologies	just bigger, but smarter, safer, and more responsive to citizen needs. Moderator - TBC Panelists - Mr. John Paul Okwiri, OGW, MBA, MCIPS, Chief Executive Officer, Konza Technopolis Development Authority - Karthikyan Gunasekar, Business Development Lead Aruba Edge Services Platform EMEA, HPE - Mr. Joseph Wanjohi, Enterprise Director, Airtel Kenya - Lucy Mbugua, Account Executive - Public Sector and Financial Services, Cisco	- Scholastica Onsongo, Senior Relations Manager, KCB Group - Africa50 - Evalyn Oloo, World Bank - Investments & New Products, KCB Group
17:15 - 18:00	Coffee Break, Exhibition Walk, Press-Briefing & Beach Games		
18:00 - 18:30	Networking Cocktail (Powered by Nia Fibre)		
18:30 - 20:00	Dinner		
20:00 - 21:00	Fireside Chat (Powered by Cisco)	Fireside Chat (Powered by Konza City)	

Day 3: Wednesday, 28 May 2025

Theme: Innovation, Inclusion, & Sector-Specific Tracks

Invite-Only Executive Breakfast (VIP Lounge) Public Sector Decision Makers & County Government Reps

Time	Event Component
07:30 - 8:00	Guest Arrival & Networking
08:00 - 08:10	Opening Remarks Stanley Kamanguya, CEO, The ICT Authority

	Computech
8:10 – 8:30	Keynote: The Role of Emerging Technologies in Public Sector Transformation Cisco
8:30 - 9:00	Roundtable Discussion: Innovation, Collaboration, & Future Prospects - Featuring key stakeholders from the public sector, Computech, Cisco, and Redington - Addressing opportunities and challenges in education, healthcare, sustainability, and governance - Interactive Q&A session.
9:00	Closing Remarks & Call to Action Computech

Time	Event Component
08:00 - 08:30	Opening Remarks Lily Ng'ok, Board Chairperson, The ICT Authority
08:30 - 10:00	Women in Tech Leadership (Dr Meister) Keynote Address Women In Tech: From The Backend To The Boardroom Despite growing representation, many women in tech still face the "sticky floor" and the "glass ceiling." How can women across Africa's tech ecosystem break through both – moving from coding and engineering roles into leadership, strategy, and influence? It's not just about gender equity – it's about leveraging diverse thinking to drive better business, innovation, and social outcomes. What does it take to thrive, lead, and change the game when you're the "first," the "only," or the "few?" - AWS - Mwende Gatabaki, CEO & Founder, Apeiro Panel Discussion Securing Her Space: Advancing Online Safety & Cybersecurity Leadership From cyberstalking and doxxing to gendered disinformation and algorithmic bias, online spaces can be disproportionately hostile to women – especially those in public-facing or leadership roles. Meanwhile, the cybersecurity industry itself remains male-dominated, despite the growing demand for diverse talent and leadership. This powerful panel brings together women who are actively reshaping the cybersecurity landscape – not only defending their own digital presence but also building safer online environments for others and rising as leaders in cyber defense, policy, and innovation. Moderator - Carol Odera, Head of Content Africa, CIO Africa by dx5 Panelists - Donna Owiti, Cybersecurity Forensics and Investigations Officer, Communications Authority of Kenya - Esther Lugoe Mengi, Founder, Cybersecurity & Digital Forensics Expert, Serensic Ltd (Tanzania) - Eunice Pohlmann, Chair, Women in Technology & Innovation Africa (WITIA) - Mutheu Khimulu, Cybersecurity Lawyer & Founder & CEO, Mutheu Khimulu Consultancy - Lorna Hardie, Regional Director Africa - Check Point Software Technologies

09:00 - 12:30	Side Event AMCHAM & Microsoft (Jumuika)		
10:00 - 12:30	Governance for Cross-Border Digital Infrastructure (Dr Meister) Keynote Address Protecting Africa's Digital Infrastructure In Times of Conflict - H.E Veronica M. Nduva, CBS, Secretary General, East African Community (EAC) Panel Discussion Harmonising Regulatory Frameworks Towards One Digital Africa As Africa races toward digital transformation, fragmented regulatory environments continue to pose a major barrier to cross-border collaboration, innovation, and scale. What does it take to create cohesive, future-ready policies that align across countries—enabling a truly integrated digital economy? There is room for data protection, telecom licensing, and spectrum management as well as FinTech, e-commerce, and digital ID interoperability. But Africa must tackle real-world challenges with real-life solutions to achieve a unified regulatory ecosystem. Moderator - Ms. Mercy Cheredi Chore, Head of the IP & TMT (Telecommunications, Media and Technology), CM Advocates LLP Panelists - Douglas Njenga Irungu, Director of Regulatory & Strategic Affairs, WIOCC Group - Andrew Kabeke, CEO, Safaricom Money Transfer Services Ltd., Safaricom PLC - Oscar Otieno, Deputy Data Commissioner for Complaints, Investigations, & Enforcement, ODPC - TBI - Juliet Maina, Africa Policy Advocacy & Partnerships at Better Than Cash Alliance, UNDP - Ms. Lydia Sitienei, Company Secretary & Director Legal Services, Communications Authority of Kenya		
10:30 - 12:00	Ministerial Roundtable		
12:30 - 14:00	Lunch, Networking, Exhibition Walk & Press-Briefing		
14:00 - 15:30	EdTech Track (Dr Meister) Remarks Reimagining Education Through Technology, Data & AI - Huawei - Mr. John Gitabi Kimotho, EdTech Consultant, EdTech Consultant - AUDA NEPAD, Spix Foundation Panel Discussion The Learning Gap: Can Technology Deliver Equity In Education? Despite the promise of technology to revolutionise education, equity remains an ongoing challenge.	AgriTech Track (Kongamano) Remarks Using Technology To Unlock African Value Dr. Kipronoh Ronoh Paul, Principal Secretary, State Department of Agriculture Panel Discussion Business Of AgriTech: Profit, Scale & Impact In Africa's Food Systems Africa's agri-food systems are at a tipping point, with technology and innovation offering the promise of transformation. The discussion will uncover what it takes to build profitable AgriTech businesses that impact smallholder farmers,	GovStack Track (Powered by GIZ) Keynote Speech & Setting the Scene Koen Doens, Director General for International Partnerships, European Commission Panel Session: Accelerating Digital Government Transformation in Africa with GovStack Africa's digital transformation is at a pivotal moment, with governments seeking to deliver citizen-centric services through scalable, interoperable, and inclusive digital platforms. GovStack, an open-source initiative, provides reusable building blocks streamline the development of digital government services. This panel will explore how African

	Moderator Panelists - Prof. Elijah Omwenga, Vice Chancellor, The Open University of Kenya - Winfred Ng'ang'a, Education Lead for East and Southern Africa, AWS - Nikki Germany, CEO, Moringa School - Prof. Robert Gateru, Vice Chancellor, Riara University - Khamis Abdallah, Principal Secretary, Ministry of Education, Zanzibar	improve food security, and scale across the continent. Moderator - Moses Liech, CEO, Investa Farm Panelists - Elizabeth Mudogo, Agri Ecosystem Lead, Loop - Mr. Henri Tonnang, Head of Data and Research Methods, IITA, CGIAR - Mr. Ramah Madiba, Chief Executive Officer, Space AI	nations can adopt GovStack to overcome barriers such as fragmented systems, limited infrastructure, and digital exclusion. Moderator: - Emmanuel Choge, TVET & Digitalisation Advisor, GIZ Kenya Panelists - Sarah Fischer, Global Programme Digital Transformation, Lead GovStack Flagship - Abdirizak Mohamed Bashir, Director ICT, Somalia - Mary Kerema, OGW, Secretary ICT, E-Government and Digital Economy - Abdallah Ibrahim Omar, General Secretary Ministry of Digital Economy, Djibouti - Steve Odhiambo, Associate Director - Growth & Partnerships Africa
15:30 - 15:45	Transition Health Break		
15:45 - 17:15	FinTech Track (Dr Meister) Remarks FinTech 2.0: Building Financial Services That Work for Everyone - Esther Waititu, Chief Financial Services Officer, Safaricom PLC Panel Discussion Beyond Payments: The Next Frontier of FinTech in Africa While mobile payments have been a game-changer for financial inclusion in Africa, the next frontier of FinTech is more than just enabling transactions. It's about unlocking new financial ecosystems that support the lending, insurance, investment, and savings, especially for the unbanked and underbanked. Explore the innovative FinTech 2.0 solutions emerging across the continent, going beyond payments to transform the entire financial ecosystem – one that is inclusive, secure, and sustainable. Moderator - Mr. Ali Hussein, Chairperson, The FinTech Alliance	Cloud Computing (Kongamano) Remarks The Cloud Advantage: Unlocking Scalable Growth for Africa's Digital Future - Djamil Jadoo Panel Discussion Edge of Innovation: How Computing Can Transform Africa's Connectivity & Service Delivery Edge computing offers a game-changing solution to connectivity and service delivery challenges, especially in remote and underserved areas. Unpack how edge computing can localise data processing, reduce latency, and support critical sectors like health, finance, agriculture, and education. Explore infrastructure investments and public - private collaboration needed to unlock the full potential of edge Moderator - Mr. Lucas Omollo, HSC - Chief Manager, ICT & Smart City Facilities, Konza City Panelists - Huawei	ManufacturingTech Track (Jumuika) Remarks Building Borderless Supply Chains: Using IoT, AI, & Blockchain to Revolutionise African Trade & Logistics Amritpal Singh, Services Business Manager, HPE (Operated by Selectium) Panel Discussion The Future Workforce: Upskilling, Safety, & Human-Robot Collaboration As the manufacturing sector accelerates toward Industry 4.0, the workforce must evolve alongside the technologies reshaping production floors. This panel brings together thought leaders and technology innovators to discuss how Africa can prepare its workers for a future defined by robotics, smart factories, and real-time operational intelligence. Let us explore strategies for upskilling at scale, embracing human-robot collaboration, and using wearable

	Panelists - Edna Atisa, Board Director, The ICT Authority - Esther Waititu, Chief Financial Services Officer, Safaricom PLC - Mr. Kagisho Dichabe, Co-Founder and Chairman, Fintech Association of South Africa (FINASA) - Mr. Kevin Mutiso, Chairperson, Digital Lenders Association of Kenya - Ms. Faith Nkatha, Country Director, Tony Blair Institute	- John Gichohi, Systems Engineer East Africa, Fortinet - Denis Mutie, Cloud Lead, Safaricom PLC - Timothy Munyao, Founder & CEO, Shinrai Technologies	tech and data-driven safety systems to protect and empower workers. Moderator - Timothy Laku, CIO/CTO Panelists - Nicholas Colosha, CEO, Nia Fibre - Dr. Kamau Gachigi, Co-Founder and Executive Director, Gearbox
17:15 - 18:00	Coffee Break, Exhibition Walk & Press-Briefing (Kongamano)		
18:00 - 19:00	Cocktail & Networking (Baobab Lawns)		
19:00 - 20:00	Dinner (Baobab Lawns)		
20:00 - 21:00	Fireside Chats		

Day 4: Thursday, 29 May 2025

Theme: Telecommunications & Connectivity

Time (EAT)	Event Component
08:00 - 08:30	Opening Remarks (Dr Meister)
08:30 - 10:00	Telecommunications & Connectivity (Dr Meister) Keynote Address Building The Backbone: Fibre Data Sharing Models & Regional Harmonisation for Seamless Connectivity - TBC Panel Discussion Driving Last-Mile Access: Harnessing Complementary Access Networks & Innovative Spectrum Strategies What are the strategies around closing the connectivity gap in underserved areas? How can last-mile access be enabled through complementary networks? How can public-private partnerships and regional collaboration expand reach and affordability? Moderator - Mr. Andrew Lewela, .KE Chief Evangelist & KeNIC CEO Panelists - Eng. Leo Boruett, Director, Multimedia Services & Ag. Director, Universal Service Fund, Kenya - Mr. William Baraza, Director & CEO, African Advanced Level Telecommunications Institute (AFRALTI)
10:00 - 10:30	Coffee Break

10:30 - 12:30	ICT Innovation (Dr Meister) Remarks From The Founder's Mouth: Scaling An African Tech Business - TBC Panel Discussion Building Sustainable Technology Companies Africa doesn't just need more tech start-ups — it needs sustainable tech businesses that can weather storms, serve real needs, and create long-term value. This panel will bring together founders, investors, and ecosystem enablers to unpack what it means to build tech companies that last. Be it securing the right kind of capital, building resilient teams, and maintaining regulatory agility, to embedding purpose, governance, and community alignment—this conversation will go beyond hype to explore what truly drives endurance, trust, and impact in African innovation. Moderator - Laviniah Muthoni, Chief Executive Officer, Greyscale Africa Panelists - Savio Wambugu, President, Association of Countrywide Innovation Hubs - Simon Sudi Ayomo, Director, The ICT Authority - Felix Ochuoga, Founder & CEO, HekoPay	Smart County Forum (Jumuika) Remarks Realising The Smart County: Local Innovation For Inclusive Digital Transformation - TBC Panel Discussion Decentralising Innovation: How ICT Is Empowering Local Governance As counties and municipalities face increasing pressure to deliver faster, smarter services, decentralised ICT solutions are emerging as revolutionary. Technology is shifting power closer to the people—enabling responsive leadership, localised innovation, and data-driven governance. Digital platforms for public services, open data for citizen accountability, and local tech ecosystems are solving real community issues. Transformation is happening outside capital cities, and the spotlight is on local government. Moderator Panelists - Mr. Charles Kevin Kamau, MPRS, Head of Strategic Partnerships, Development Sector Relations & Private Sector Coordination, County Government of Kilifi - Maurine Awuor Onyango, Director ICT, Department of Finance, Economic Planning and ICT (E-Government) Services, County Government of Kisumu - Josephine Muema, Head of County Business & Midmarket Enterprises, Safaricom PLC	Inclusive by Design: Investing in the Future of Assistive Tech Start-ups (Powered by Silicon Overdrive) (Kongamano) Opening Remarks - Prof Joshua G. Bagaka, Deputy Vice-Chancellor, Academic and Student Affairs, KCA University Keynote Address - Prof Isaiah I.C. Wakindiki, Vice Chancellor & CEO, KCA University & Panel Discussion The momentum for developing and scaling assistive technology (AT) has been rising in Africa but there still remains a ripe chance of accelerating this growth to a pace needed to meet the substantial market need. We can add to the efforts that both government and private sector are making to include universal designs and products in mainstream market by creating awareness of the investability of AT innovations and start-ups in Africa. Moderator: - Eric Odipo, Country Lead, Silicon Overdrive Panelists: - Surpana Biswas, CEO, Kilimanjaro Blind Trust Africa (KBTA) - Bernard Chiira, CEO, AT4D - Ms. Clarah Ketyanya, Board Director, The ICT Authority
12:30 - 14:00	Networking Lunch		
14:00 - 15:30	Closing Ceremony		
17:00 - 19:00	Gala Dinner & Innovation Awards Ceremony (Kivulini Cove Beach)		